

BITCOIN INVESTMENT RESEARCH REPORT

June 30, 2026 Bottom Assessment

Investment mandate

Assess whether the June 30, 2026 Bitcoin low represents a credible cycle-bottom candidate and translate the evidence into an actionable investment decision framework.

Prepared as investment research

Market structure • On-chain valuation • Capital flows • Derivatives positioning • Historical cycle analysis

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1. Executive Investment Summary

The June 30, 2026 Bitcoin low is a credible candidate for a cycle bottom, but the available evidence does not establish it as a confirmed cycle bottom. The investment question is therefore not simply whether to buy or sell; it is whether the evidence supports initiating or increasing exposure while maintaining defined downside controls.

CYCLE PEAK	\$124.82K
JUNE 30 CYCLE BOTTOM	\$58.53K
CYCLE DRAWDOWN	-53.11%
RECOVERY FROM BOTTOM	30.52%

Investment stance: measured exposure with confirmation.

The research supports treating the June 30 low as a reference point for staged exposure rather than as proof that downside risk has been eliminated. A stronger allocation case would require continued recovery, improving capital flows and confirmation from market positioning.

Key evidence

- The market has recovered 30.52% from the June 30 low, providing meaningful post-bottom evidence.
- Current MVRV is 1.47, above the June 30 reading but still materially below the extreme valuation levels associated with late-cycle euphoria.
- The cycle drawdown of 53.11% is materially smaller than the historical drawdowns observed in the 2011, 2013, 2015, 2018 and 2022 cycle-bottom datasets.
- ETF flows and derivatives positioning remain important confirmation variables. Recent ETF conditions have improved at points, but flows have also reversed into outflows, demonstrating that institutional demand is not yet a one-directional signal.

The principal conclusion is therefore conditional: June 30 can be used as a working bottom reference, but the thesis should be increased in confidence only as independent evidence confirms it.

2. Market Drawdown & Recovery Assessment

Bitcoin declined from the cycle peak of \$124.82K to the June 30 low of \$58.53K, producing a 53.11% peak-to-bottom drawdown over 267 days. The recovery has subsequently reached 30.52% from that low.

Historical comparison

The dashboard's historical cycle dataset records substantially deeper drawdowns: 92.75% in 2011, 71.24% in 2013, 84.52% in 2015, 83.78% in 2018 and 76.67% in 2022. The 2026 drawdown is therefore less severe than every historical cycle-bottom drawdown represented in the dataset.

Interpretation: Drawdown magnitude alone does not confirm a cycle bottom. It does, however, establish that the current decline has been materially less severe than prior cycle resets. This reduces the usefulness of historical drawdown depth as a standalone confirmation signal and increases the importance of valuation, flows and recovery structure.

Recovery timing

Historical recovery speeds vary considerably. In the dashboard dataset, time to +30% recovery ranges from 5 days in 2013 to 108 days in 2018, with 66 days in 2022. The current cycle reached +30% in approximately 52 days. This places the current recovery within the broad historical range rather than at an extreme.

Investment implication

The recovery is substantial enough to warrant treating June 30 as an important structural reference, but it remains insufficient on its own to establish a durable new bull phase. Confirmation should come from multiple independent evidence layers.

3. Valuation & On-Chain Evidence

MVRV provides a valuation lens by comparing Bitcoin's market value with realized value. The dashboard records MVRV at the June 30 low at approximately 1.10 and the latest dashboard reading at 1.47.

Historical context

The dashboard's historical MVRV-at-bottom observations are: 2011: 0.42; 2013: 1.35; 2015: 0.56; 2018: 0.69; 2022: 0.75; 2026: 1.10. This shows that prior cycle bottoms have often occurred at lower MVRV levels, although the 2013 observation demonstrates that a cycle low does not require MVRV to fall below 1.

Valuation conclusion: The June 30 reading is consistent with a materially reset valuation regime, but it is not an exact historical match to prior cycle-bottom MVRV behavior. The current MVRV of 1.47 indicates that the market has repriced materially upward from the low.

Realized price relationship

The latest dashboard realized price is approximately \$53.19K, placing current Bitcoin roughly 43.61% above realized price. This indicates that the market remains above the aggregate realized-cost reference represented in the model.

External on-chain research provides similar context. Glassnode described the July environment as a bottom-building process in which Bitcoin remained in deep value while ETF outflows persisted and derivatives had de-risked.

■cite■turn0search1■

A later Glassnode market pulse reported that spot, derivatives and ETF flows had softened again by September 14, while price remained within its range and new capital continued entering the broader market. ■cite■turn0search3■

4. Capital Flows & Institutional Demand

ETF flows are a key confirmation variable because they provide a direct observable measure of institutional capital entering or leaving U.S. spot Bitcoin ETFs.

The dashboard currently records cumulative ETF flow at approximately -1.61K BTC. This is a caution signal within the project's dataset and should not be interpreted as a standalone sell signal.

External flow data shows that the regime has been volatile rather than uniformly negative. TBTC's tracker records large outflow days around June 30 and subsequent inflow periods, including a \$159.5M net inflow on September 17.

■cite■turn0search6■ Glassnode likewise reported a strong seven-day period of \$2.23B in U.S. spot ETF inflows during a later September rally, while noting the broader importance of capital flow behavior. ■cite■turn0search2■

Investment implication: ETF flows should be monitored as a confirmation mechanism rather than treated as a binary signal. A sustained transition toward positive net flows would strengthen the demand side of the thesis; renewed persistent outflows would weaken it.

Source transparency

The external ETF flow tracker states that its daily flow calculations are derived from ETF issuer data and converted into USD using the closing exchange rate. ■cite■turn0search4■

5. Derivatives & Market Positioning

CME open interest and net positioning are included to assess whether the recovery is being accompanied by increasing market participation and changing positioning.

The dashboard shows CME open interest rising above 22,000 before declining toward approximately 19,700. Net positioning shows large speculators positive, commercials negative and small traders closer to neutral/negative during the July–September period.

These measures are not independently predictive. Their value is in confirming whether the price recovery is accompanied by meaningful changes in participation, leverage and positioning.

Glassnode's September 14 market pulse similarly described futures open interest as elevated but no longer growing, while perpetual futures selling intensified and ETF flows reversed to outflows. ■cite■turn0search3■

Positioning conclusion: Derivatives evidence currently supports continued monitoring rather than a definitive directional call. A healthy recovery would ideally be accompanied by controlled leverage and improving spot/capital-flow conditions rather than an unstable increase in speculative positioning.

6. Historical Cycle Recovery Analysis

The recovery analysis compares the current post-June 30 path with prior Bitcoin cycle bottoms using standardized recovery milestones.

The dashboard records time to +30% recovery as 11 days in 2011, 5 days in 2013, 8 days in 2015, 108 days in 2018, 66 days in 2022 and approximately 52 days for 2026. The current recovery therefore falls within the historical distribution.

The recovery milestone table also shows why a single threshold should not be treated as confirmation. Previous cycles have reached +50% and +100% at very different speeds. The 2022 cycle, for example, required 81 days to reach +50% and 348 days to reach +100%, while earlier cycles recovered much faster.

Research interpretation: The current recovery is meaningful, but historical data does not provide a single universal recovery threshold that confirms a bottom. The appropriate approach is to combine recovery progress with valuation, flows and positioning.

7. Integrated Investment Thesis

The evidence can be separated into supporting factors and caution factors.

Supporting the June 30 bottom thesis

- 30.52% recovery from the June 30 low.
- Current MVRV of 1.47 following a June 30 reading near 1.10.
- Historical recovery timing is consistent with the broad range observed after prior cycle lows.
- Market positioning and open interest provide additional evidence that the market has moved beyond the immediate bottoming phase.

Requiring caution

- ETF flows have remained volatile and can return to net outflows.
- The current cycle has not yet demonstrated the longer-duration recovery evidence available for completed historical cycles.
- The current drawdown was shallower than prior cycle-bottom drawdowns, meaning historical depth is not sufficient confirmation.
- Macro conditions and liquidity can materially change Bitcoin's path independently of on-chain valuation.

Integrated assessment: The balance of evidence supports using June 30 as a credible working-bottom reference, but not as a confirmed cycle-bottom declaration.

8. Investment Recommendation

For an investment committee deciding whether to increase or reduce crypto exposure, the research supports a **measured exposure with confirmation** framework.

- 1. Avoid treating the June 30 low as fully confirmed.** The evidence is supportive but incomplete.
- 2. Use staged exposure rather than a single binary entry decision.** The current recovery creates an opportunity to participate while retaining capital for confirmation or renewed weakness.
- 3. Increase confidence as independent evidence converges.** Improving spot/ETF flows, sustained recovery, controlled derivatives leverage and continued constructive valuation behavior would strengthen the thesis.
- 4. Maintain a defined invalidation reference.** The June 30 low and the \$58.53K cycle-bottom level should remain central downside reference points for this research framework.

Recommendation: Treat the June 30 low as a credible candidate cycle bottom and consider measured exposure subject to confirmation. The research does not support treating the bottom as definitively confirmed or removing downside controls.

9. Principal Risks & Invalidation Framework

The thesis can weaken through several observable developments:

- **Price invalidation:** sustained failure of the June 30 low / \$58.53K reference would materially weaken the bottom thesis.
- **Flow deterioration:** persistent ETF net outflows would weaken the institutional-demand case.
- **Valuation deterioration:** renewed compression in MVRV toward or below historical low regimes would indicate renewed stress.
- **Derivatives stress:** rapidly increasing leverage combined with falling spot prices would raise liquidation and volatility risk.
- **Macro/liquidity shock:** changes in rates, dollar liquidity, Treasury yields or risk appetite can overwhelm crypto-specific signals.

These are decision triggers, not forecasts. They are intended to define what evidence would change the investment thesis.

10. Final Investment Committee Conclusion

Conclusion

The June 30, 2026 Bitcoin low exhibits several characteristics consistent with historical cycle-bottom conditions: a substantial drawdown, a meaningful valuation reset, and a subsequent recovery exceeding 30%. However, the available evidence does not establish the low as a confirmed cycle bottom while the current cycle remains ongoing.

For an investment committee, the appropriate interpretation is therefore conditional rather than binary. June 30 should be treated as a credible candidate cycle bottom and a key reference point for exposure decisions, while confirmation should be sought through continued price recovery, improving capital flows, controlled derivatives positioning and stable on-chain valuation metrics.

The framework favors **measured exposure with confirmation** rather than an all-in or all-out decision. The principal risk to the thesis is a sustained break below the June 30 / \$58.53K reference accompanied by deteriorating flows and renewed valuation stress.

This report is an investment-research framework based on the project's dashboard data and the external sources listed below. It is not personalized investment advice.

Appendix A. Methodology & Data Notes

The analysis combines the project's Power BI/PostgreSQL research model with historical Bitcoin cycle data, MVRV/realized-price measures, ETF flow data and CME market-positioning observations. Historical comparisons are descriptive and do not imply that future cycles must repeat prior behavior.

Dashboard snapshot values used in the report include: cycle peak \$124.82K; June 30 cycle bottom \$58.53K; drawdown -53.11%; peak-to-bottom duration 267 days; recovery from June 30 30.52%; current MVRV 1.47; realized price \$53.19K; BTC premium to realized price 43.61%; cumulative ETF flow -1.61K BTC; days since bottom 79.

External Sources & References

The following links are the actual source pages used to provide external market context. No AI-generated source or ChatGPT URL is used.

Glassnode — Bottom Building in Progress (July 8, 2026)

<https://research.glassnode.com/the-week-onchain-week-27-2026/>

Glassnode — Squeeze into Supply (September 2026)

<https://research.glassnode.com/the-week-onchain-week-34-2026/>

Glassnode — BTC Market Pulse: Week 38 (September 14, 2026)

<https://research.glassnode.com/btc-market-pulse-week-38-2026/>

Glassnode Studio — US Spot ETF Flows methodology/data

<https://studio.glassnode.com/charts/institutions.UsSpotEtfFlowsAll?a=BTC&c=usd>

TFTC — Bitcoin ETF Flows tracker

<https://www.tftc.io/bitcoin-etf-flows>

BGeometrics — The Cycle That Never Got Euphoric: Bitcoin's Deep-Value Reset

<https://bgeometrics.com/blog/2026-07-bitcoin-cycle-never-got-euphoric-deep-value/>

Reuters — Mapping the Market: Bitcoin has challenges to face after dramatic surge

<https://www.reuters.com/markets/global-markets-technicals-graphic-2026-09-03/>